



Project Title	Rising Waters: Machine Learning Based Flood Prediction System		
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Date	26 June	Phase / Document	Requirement Analysis

6. Solution Requirements

Requirements were split into functional requirements (what the system must do) and non-functional requirements (the qualities the system must have while doing it), following the standard split used in the design-thinking phases above. Each functional requirement below traces directly to a concrete piece of code in `app.py` or `train.py`, so that the requirement list can be verified against the implementation rather than treated as an aspirational document.

6.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-1	Accept user-provided meteorological inputs (temperature, humidity, cloud cover, seasonal and annual rainfall).
FR-2	Provide an Auto-Fill option to instantly populate the form with realistic demo values.
FR-3	Scale input features using the same Standard Scaler used during training.
FR-4	Predict flood probability and classify it into Normal / Elevated / Severe tiers.
FR-5	Generate dynamic, human-readable insights explaining the prediction.
FR-6	Display recommended safety protocols corresponding to the severity tier.
FR-7	Handle invalid/missing input gracefully and surface an error message in the UI.

6.2 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
NFR-1	Usability — responsive, single-page interface usable on desktop and mobile.
NFR-2	Performance — prediction response returned within a few seconds of form submission.
NFR-3	Maintainability — training (<code>train.py</code>) and serving (<code>app.py</code>) logic kept separate and independently runnable.
NFR-4	Portability — trained artifacts serialized via Joblib for reuse without retraining.
NFR-5	Reliability — model and scaler existence validated at startup before serving requests.

NFR-5 in particular reflects a deliberate defensive choice in `app.py`: the application raises a File Not Found Error at import time if `flood_model.joblib` or `scaler.joblib` are missing, rather than failing silently or crashing on the first prediction request. This trades a slightly less friendly startup error for a guarantee that, if the server is running at all, it is running with a valid model.

